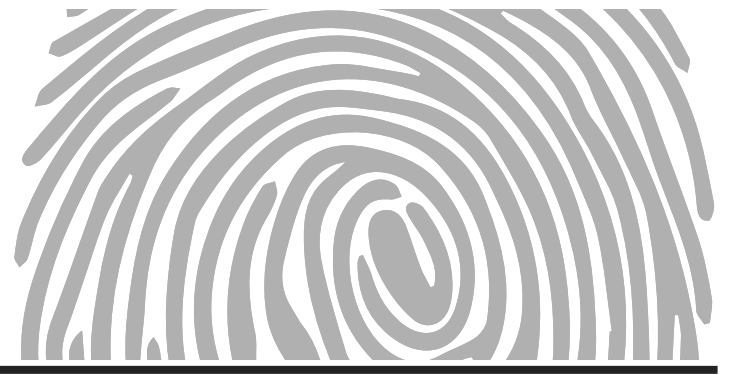


THE SLEUTH

BLACKMAN DETECTIVE SERVICES
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SEPTEMBER 2024



FROM THE CASE FILES: THEODORE P.I. BEARRINGTON

We had a stalker on our hands. A father was worried that his daughter, Janae, was being stalked by her ex-boyfriend. Janae had initially moved away for college to study hospitality but the ex-boyfriend didn't want her to go. Reluctantly, he tried to move on, but when she moved back in town to start her new job on night shift at a local fancy hotel, he was all too thrilled. An unsuspecting accountant, himself, he found out through a friend that she was back in the area. The daughter's father reached out after the daughter called him, claiming she thought she saw him waiting for her in the parking garage for the past few mornings. He begged us to investigate the issue. Sounded like a case for a P.I., alright.

Equipped with video camera in hand, I drove out to get into position. This was going to be a case staking out the ex-boyfriend in the parking garage where he would apparently just sit in his car and watch for a glimpse of Janae getting off of her night shift in the mornings. I sat there, digging into my breakfast. I was enjoying a gobble of pancake, a little drop of Mickey Dee's syrup, a sip of iced coffee, a bite of a hash brown - when all of a sudden, I noticed something that caught my eye. The ex-boyfriend was not alone in his car. Someone was sitting in the passenger seat, rather tall - and, no offense, but they were rather wide, too, and dare I say it, covered in fur! I zoomed in with my video camera. Turns out that it was a bear! Well, a teddy bear... the giant kind you win at carnivals to try and impress your girl. Oh boy. I knew where this was headed.

It was at that very moment that Janae walked out from the elevator doors into the parking garage, a nervous look on her face. Her ex-boyfriend then got out of his vehicle, holding the giant teddy bear and began to approach her. She didn't see him yet, though, based on where he was parked. I decided now was the time to intervene.

"Good morning, sir! Let me stop you right *bear!*" I called out to him. "Thank you *beary* much for this sweet gift!" I then took the bear out of his hands, still somehow managing to record on my video camera.

The ex-boyfriend looked at the camera in my hands and then over at Janae, who was now clicking her seatbelt and about to drive off. I raised my eyebrows at him and he soon realized what was going on - I could tell by the horror on his face. He raised his hands up in a gesture of surrender, walking backwards.

"I won't follow her anymore!" he cried. "Janae was my first love, you know. Keep the bear. I won't be needing it anymore..." Then, he actually hugged me, much like a cub needing an embrace from its mama bear. There's certainly never a dull moment in this job, that's for sure!

I updated the client and was retained to make sure that he didn't come back for the next few weeks which he thankfully did not. while the boy may have found up alone, i had a new investigator friend by my side, Theodore P.I. Bearrington. the case was finally resolved, which dare I say it, made me feel *fuzzy* inside.

LITTLE RED FLAGS: IS SOMEONE LYING TO YOU?



While body language cannot always depict if someone is lying to you, the following signs show there is a good chance that they might not be telling the truth:

- Giving too many details in a story
- On the other hand, not saying much or leaving out most details
- Avoiding making eye contact
- Acting "fidgety" and can't stay still
- Placing blame on others and avoiding accountability through defensiveness

[SOURCE:
FORENSICSCOLLEGES.COM]

JUST THE (FUN) FACTS: LIFE AS A PI



There are two major approaches to conducting surveillance: mobile and stationary.

Mobile surveillance is when an investigator monitors the Subject's movement and actions in possibly multiple locations, either by vehicle or on foot.

Stationary surveillance is when an investigator monitors the Subject in one particular spot. An example of this would be to determine if a Paramour is visiting the Subject's residence at night.

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CYBERSECURITY CORNER

HOW TO PROTECT YOUR DIGITAL DATA: RANSOMWARE ATTACKS

Ransomware attacks involve malicious software placed on your computer that encrypt your files. This means you’re unable to read or access your files until you pay the hackers a fee, typically via cryptocurrency such as bitcoin.

The hackers will also typically threaten to sell your data and/or leak your private information to the darkweb if the ransom is not paid in a timely manner.

If this happens to you, report it to the FBI and your local law enforcement agency.

[SOURCE: FBI.GOV]



NOT TODAY, SCAMMERS!

SCAMS TO KNOW ABOUT: VISHING

Vishing (voice phishing) occurs when a fraudulent phone call is used to try to obtain sensitive information from the victim, such as financial account information.

Signs that you may be on the phone with a visher include someone pretending to be a member of tech support or an IRS employee. They will ask you for information regarding your user logins and passwords, your social security number, and/or similar sensitive credentials.

[SOURCE: CISCO.COM]



CLIENT TESTIMONIAL

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